

ClamAV: Use this Open Source Software to Protect your Operating System



ClamAV is an actively maintained and highly secure open source antivirus software. It is extremely lightweight, which makes it ideal for any device. It is available for all major operating systems including Linux, MacOS, Windows and Solaris. In this article, we demonstrate how to install and run an antivirus scan using ClamAV.

Antivirus software is an important add-on to any operating system, especially if the OS is connected to other computers on a network. While there are not many malware or trojans created specifically to target Linux, your computer may still be vulnerable to other vulnerable computers on the network. Linux is highly secure, but not infallible. So you need an open source, highly secure, regularly updated and (ideally) lightweight antivirus for your Linux based OS. And that is exactly the requirement that ClamAV fulfils. With its latest stable version (v0.102.0) released recently, ClamAV is currently the only open source antivirus software that is updated and maintained regularly by an active community.

The salient features of ClamAV are:

- Open source and regularly updated
- Highly secure
- Supports all major operating systems (Linux, MacOS, Windows and Solaris)
- Extremely lightweight and runs well on devices with low configurations
- Capable of detecting infections in a wide array of file types

Installing ClamAV

While the installation process for ClamAV is pretty straightforward in most operating systems, there are a couple of more steps involved if you are trying to do so on Windows or MacOS machines. For instance, for MacOS, the best option is to install

Linux Packages	
Ubuntu	
Debian	
SuSE	
RedHat & Fedora	
Fedora & EPEL	
Mandriva	
Gentoo	
Pardus	
3SD Packages	
FreeBSD	
OpenBSD	

Figure 1: Packages for different Linux distros